

MSI Prestige 16 AI

Performance that gets the job done

Being a tech journalist, I can get work done on almost any half-decent laptop.

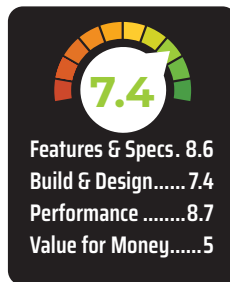
Entering into 2026, there is no shortage of capable machines to choose from, either. But when I look at a laptop through the lens of a creator, expectations change. Performance needs to be strong enough to handle demanding workflows, and the display has to be good enough not just for consuming content, but for creating it as well. Editing photos, reviewing footage, writing for hours, and juggling multiple tools at once is part of my daily routine.

That was the mindset I was in when the MSI Prestige 16 AI Evo arrived for review. I approached it less like a general-purpose laptop and more like a potential creative companion. Over days of real-world use, switching between writing, image editing, and the occasional stress test, the Prestige 16 AI revealed itself. It does not chase attention or try to impress in the first five minutes. Instead, it grows on you quietly through consistency. So, should you go ahead and invest around Rs 2 lakh on this laptop?

DESIGN AND BUILD

The first thing I noticed when I picked up the MSI Prestige 16 AI is just how understated it looks. It does not try to make a bold design statement, and in many ways, that feels intentional. The chassis feels solid without being overly heavy, and the dark grey finish, paired with subtle MSI branding on the lid, keeps things clean and professional. This is a laptop I would be perfectly comfortable carrying into a meeting, a cafe, or a co-working space without it standing out for the wrong reasons.

₹2,12,990



That said, if you enjoy laptops that experiment with bold designs or double up as style statements, this one might feel a little too safe. Personally, I did find myself wishing for more character, and throwing on a colourful sleeve felt like the easiest way to give it some personality without taking away from its professional appeal.

In terms of build quality, the MSI Prestige 16 AI has a premium metal build that feels solid in the hand. However, the sturdiness is not uniform across the chassis. When the lid is shut, and you apply a bit of pressure, there is some noticeable flex. The 180-degree hinge also feels slightly delicate, and the display tends to wobble if you open the laptop too quickly. It is not a deal-breaker, but it does remind you that this machine prioritises thinness and portability over tank-like rigidity.

Despite being a 16-inch machine, it never felt bulky. Slipping it into a backpack did not feel like a commitment, and carrying it around the house or to work was surprisingly manageable.

Apart from this, it was the keyboard I spent most of my time with, and it is

perfectly fine for long writing sessions. Key travel is comfortable, spacing is sensible, and after a few hours, I stopped thinking about it, which is usually the best compliment. The touchpad is smooth, responsive, and large enough to not feel cramped during gesture-heavy navigation. I even found myself working without a mouse, and that's something that I usually don't do unless the touchpad does its job really well.

DISPLAY AND PORTS

If your work involves working with videos and images, you will need a device that has spot-on colour accuracy. Thankfully, the MSI Prestige 16 AI delivers in that area. Using the laptop for photo edits and video previews felt comfortable and reliable.

According to Calman results, the panel covers 97.2% of the sRGB colour space and an impressive 99.3% of DCI-P3, which immediately puts it in creator-friendly territory. What this means in day-to-day use is simple. Colours look consistent and believable, whether you are tweaking images, reviewing footage, or just consuming content.

The Calman tests also showed an average Delta E of 1.7, which shows that even if there are any colour differences, they are hard to spot with the naked eye. You can rely on this laptop's display for creative decisions. Brightness levels are adequate for indoor use. I also used the laptop while sitting near a window and faced no issues in terms of brightness.

Coming to ports, MSI has been sensible with options, and I appreciated that more than I expected. Having a mix of USB-C, USB-A, HDMI, and Ethernet meant I rarely had to reach for a dongle. Thunderbolt support also adds flexibility for docks and fast storage, and charging over USB-C makes life easier when travelling. With that being said, the placement of the ports is something I found to be a hindrance at times. Most ports are located at the back, and this meant I had to constantly get up from my seat to plug in